

Tiffin Bay Montessori School



Parent Handbook 2026/2027

Welcome to Tiffin Bay Montessori — Midland's first and only Montessori school.

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, our approach is grounded in the time-tested philosophy of Maria Montessori, where children are naturally driven to explore, discover, and master their environment from an early age.

As the first Montessori program of its kind in the Midland community, we are proud to offer a thoughtfully prepared environment that brings this globally respected approach to local families. Our classrooms are intentionally designed with limited spaces to ensure individualized attention, strong relationships, and a calm, purposeful learning experience for every child.

Due to the unique nature of our program and our commitment to maintaining small class sizes, enrollment is limited. Spaces are offered in accordance with the centre's Wait List Policy and Procedures.

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we are not simply a childcare centre—we are a foundation for lifelong learning, independence, and confidence.

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, our educators honour each child as an individual, respecting their unique interests, pace, and abilities. Guided by the principles of Maria Montessori, teachers create a prepared environment where children are free to explore, make choices, and develop independence, fostering a lifelong love of learning. We are committed to an inclusive and welcoming community—Tiffin Bay Montessori admits children of all backgrounds and does not discriminate on the basis of race, colour, or ethnic origin in any aspect of our programs or policies.

Our Program

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, our program is grounded in the principles of Maria Montessori and reflects our commitment to nurturing the whole child. We view each child as capable, competent, curious, and rich in potential.

Our program is delivered through a carefully prepared environment that encourages exploration, independence, and purposeful activity. Educators act as guides, observing and responding to each child's interests and developmental needs, while fostering self-regulation, confidence, and a strong sense of belonging.

We support learning through play, inquiry, and hands-on experiences, both indoors and outdoors. Children are given opportunities to make choices, solve problems, and engage in meaningful interactions with peers, educators, and their environment.

Our approach emphasizes respect, collaboration, and inclusivity, while promoting health, safety, nutrition, and overall well-being. We are committed to continuous reflection and professional growth, ensuring our program evolves to meet the needs of our children, families, and community.

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Services Offered

Tiffin Bay Montessori provides licensed full-day childcare services for the following age groups:

- Toddler Program (18 months to 30 months)
- Preschool/Casa Program (30 months to 5 years)

Care is provided Monday to Friday during regular operating hours.

Regular Hours

Full Day: 7:45 a.m. – 5:30 p.m.

Times of Service

Tiffin Bay Montessori operates Monday to Friday from 7:45 a.m. to 5:30 p.m.

Messages and Phone Calls

Any phone calls or messages must be made through the office number. Calls to teachers should be made at noon or before/after school hours.

Registration

To register your child (18 months to 5 years old), submit the following:

1. A completed Enrolment application form
2. A completed Record of Immunization as required by Simcoe Muskoka District Health Unit.
3. A deposit equivalent to up to four (4) weeks of the CWELCC-approved parent fee is required to secure enrollment.
4. Parent Handbook Read and Signed all pages

Staffing & Supervision Policy

Tiffin Bay Montessori follows all staffing and supervision requirements as outlined by the Ministry of Education under the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA). These standards are in place to ensure the safety, well-being, and quality of care for all children within our program.

Our program operates within the following educator-to-child ratios and group sizes:

Age Group	Age Range	Educator to Child Ratio	Maximum Group Size
Toddlers	18 months to 30 months	1:5	15
Preschool	30 months to 6 years	1:8	24

Tiffin Bay Montessori is committed to always maintaining these ratios and may exceed minimum requirements where appropriate to support the needs of the children and ensure a high-quality learning environment.

Reduced Ratios (Permitted Exceptions)

In accordance with CCEYA regulations, reduced ratios may be implemented during specific periods of the day, including the first ninety (90) minutes of operation, during designated rest periods, and up to one (1) hour prior to closing.

Reduced ratios may be as follows:

Age Group	Reduced Ratio (Educator to Children)	Maximum Group Size
Toddlers	Up to 1:8	15
Preschool	Up to 1:12	24

Reduced ratios are applied only where permitted and in a manner that continues to ensure appropriate supervision, safety, and program quality.

At all times, educators provide active supervision, guidance, and support to children within a prepared Montessori environment that promotes independence, respect, and engagement. Staffing decisions are made with careful consideration of children's needs, room dynamics, and safety requirements.

Tiffin Bay Montessori remains committed to maintaining a safe, responsive, and high-quality program and may exceed regulatory requirements where appropriate to best support the children in our care.

Our Goal

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, our goal is to provide a safe, nurturing, and developmentally appropriate environment for toddlers and preschool-aged children. Rooted in the philosophy of Maria Montessori, we believe that children are naturally capable, curious, and driven to learn.

Our program is guided by the Montessori approach, with a thoughtfully prepared environment that encourages independence, exploration, and purposeful activity. Through hands-on learning and meaningful experiences, we support each child's social-emotional, physical, and cognitive development, while fostering confidence, self-regulation, and a lifelong love of learning.

We strive to create a harmonious connection between home and school by offering a consistent, respectful, and supportive environment for both children and families. Our program is designed to meet the intellectual, moral, social-emotional, and physical needs of each child, allowing them to grow and thrive at their own pace.

Program Statement

Program Goal: To teach the children to be independent and develop inner discipline. The teacher's role is to observe and guide the learning without interrupting; when this is done, the children

become independent learners - mastering skills, sounds, and numbers. They become active participants, and purposeful learners.

Alignment with the Minister's Policy Statement on Programming and Pedagogy (CCEYA)

Tiffin Bay Montessori School Inc. is committed to ensuring that all programs and practices are consistent with the Minister's Policy Statement on Programming and Pedagogy under the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA).

Our approach reflects the following guiding principles:

View of the Child

We view every child as competent, capable, curious, and rich in potential. Each child is respected as an individual with unique strengths, interests, and developmental pathways.

Promoting Health, Safety, Nutrition, and Well-Being

The health, safety, and well-being of children are foundational to all practices. We provide a safe, clean, and nurturing environment that supports healthy development, including proper nutrition, rest, and active play.

Positive and Responsive Interactions

Educators engage in warm, respectful, and responsive relationships with children. Staff act as positive role models and foster trusting relationships that support emotional security and belonging.

Supporting Self-Regulation and Positive Communication

Children are supported in developing self-regulation skills through guidance, modeling, and consistent routines. Educators encourage children to communicate their needs, emotions, and ideas in positive and appropriate ways.

Fostering Exploration, Play, and Inquiry

Children learn through play, exploration, and inquiry. Educators provide opportunities for hands-on, meaningful experiences that reflect children's natural curiosity and interests.

Child-Initiated and Adult-Supported Learning

Programs are designed to support both child-initiated experiences and intentional adult guidance. Educators observe, extend, and scaffold learning opportunities based on each child's development.

Creating Positive Learning Environments

The environment is carefully prepared to promote engagement, independence, and learning. Spaces are inclusive, accessible, and reflect the interests and needs of the children.

Balanced Daily Experiences

Children participate in a balance of indoor and outdoor play, active and quiet experiences, and rest periods, supporting holistic development.

Family Engagement and Communication

We value strong partnerships with families. Ongoing communication ensures that families are informed, involved, and supported in their child's learning journey.

Community Partnerships

We collaborate with local community partners and professionals to support children's development and well-being.

Continuous Professional Learning

Educators engage in ongoing professional development to enhance their knowledge, skills, and practices in early learning and childcare.

Training and Professional Development

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we are committed to continuous growth, excellence, and reflective practice. Our educators are lifelong learners who regularly enhance their knowledge and skills to ensure the highest standard of care and authentic Montessori implementation.

All educators are Montessori-trained and accredited through Montessori Accreditation Council for Teacher Education and participate in ongoing professional development to remain current with best practices, licensing standards, and educational approaches. Each staff member maintains valid First Aid and CPR Level C certification, completes WHMIS and Health & Safety training, receives EpiPen training upon hire and annually thereafter. First aid kits are always available.

Educators complete a minimum of ten (10) hours of professional development annually. This includes participation in workshops and online training offered through Simcoe County, as well as attendance at annual Montessori conferences when available. These opportunities support continuous learning, reflection, and collaboration among staff. Registered Early Childhood Educators (RECEs) also meet the Continuous Professional Learning requirements set by the College of Early Childhood Educators.

Nutrition & Mealtime Approach

Nutrition at Tiffin Bay Montessori is approached with care, intention, and alignment with Montessori principles. Children are provided with nutritious meals and snacks that follow Canada's Food Guide and support their overall health and well-being. Drinking water is available throughout the day and offered regularly.

In keeping with the Montessori philosophy, children are encouraged to develop independence and practical life skills during mealtimes. They are given opportunities to participate in preparing snacks, setting the table, and serving themselves in a safe and supportive environment.

Individual dietary needs, allergies, and feeding instructions are respected and accommodated. Written documentation of any special dietary requirements must be provided and will be maintained in the child's file to ensure consistency and safety.

Parent-Provided Food and Drink

Where parents/guardians provide food or drink for their child, the following requirements must be met to ensure the safety of all children:

- all food and drink items must be **clearly labelled with the child's full name**
- parents must provide **written instructions regarding feeding, dietary arrangements, or any substitutions/supplements**
- parents are responsible for ensuring that food and drink items **do not contain any ingredients that may place another child at risk of an allergic reaction**
- staff will **inspect all food and drink items upon arrival** to ensure compliance with centre restrictions and allergy requirements
- any food or drink items that are not permitted or that pose a potential risk will be **removed and returned to the parent**, and the incident will be **documented in the daily written record**
- the centre reserves the right to **prohibit specific food items** where necessary to protect children with life-threatening allergies

A Community of Belonging & Inclusion

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we believe that every child is unique, capable, and deserving of a deep sense of belonging within our community. Guided by the philosophy of Maria Montessori, we recognize and honor each child's individual strengths, interests, and potential.

Our prepared Montessori environment is designed to support all children in developing independence, confidence, and meaningful connections. Through purposeful activity and respectful interactions, children are encouraged to explore, engage, and express themselves in ways that reflect their individuality.

We are committed to creating an inclusive environment where children of all abilities are welcomed and supported. Each child is provided with equitable opportunities to participate fully in the program, fostering positive relationships, empathy, and collaboration among peers.

Educators are responsive to the diverse needs of each child and work closely with families and community partners to support individualized learning and development. Where appropriate, individualized support plans are developed to ensure that every child can thrive within the Montessori environment.

Our program aligns with Ontario's *How Does Learning Happen?* framework and the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA), reinforcing our belief that children are competent, capable, curious, and rich in potential.

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, inclusion is not simply a practice, it is a foundation of our community, where every child is valued, respected, and supported to reach their fullest potential.

Prohibited Practices & Positive Guidance

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we are committed to fostering a respectful, nurturing, and emotionally safe environment where each child is supported in developing independence, self-regulation, and positive relationships. Our approach to guidance is grounded in the principles of Maria Montessori and aligns with the requirements of the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA).

Prohibited Practices

In accordance with the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA), Tiffin Bay Montessori strictly prohibits the following practices:

- Corporal punishment of a child
- Inflicting any bodily harm on children, including making children eat or drink against their will
- Physical restraint of a child, except as permitted under the CCEYA
- Locking the exits of the child care centre for the purpose of confining a child
- Use of harsh or degrading measures or threats that would humiliate, shame, or frighten a child
- Depriving a child of basic needs including food, drink, shelter, sleep, toilet use, clothing, or bedding
- Any form of verbal or emotional abuse

All staff, students, and volunteers are required to always adhere to these standards.

These practices are not permitted under any circumstances.

Positive Guidance Approach

Our educators use respectful, responsive, and developmentally appropriate strategies to guide children's behavior. This includes:

- Supporting children in developing self-regulation through calm, consistent, and predictable routines
- Modeling respectful communication and problem-solving
- Redirecting behavior in a positive and constructive manner
- Encouraging independence and offering choices within clear and consistent boundaries
- Observing and understanding the underlying needs or emotions behind a child's behavior
- Promoting empathy, cooperation, and conflict resolution among peers

Educators work collaboratively with families to support each child's development and ensure a consistent, supportive approach between home and school.

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, guidance is rooted in respect, patience, and understanding—supporting each child to develop confidence, responsibility, and a strong sense of self within a safe and caring environment.

Duty to Report

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, the safety and well-being of every child is our highest priority. In accordance with the Child, Youth and Family Services Act (CYFSA), all individuals—including educators—have a legal duty to immediately report any reasonable suspicion that a child may be in need of protection to a Children's Aid Society.

Guided by the principles of Maria Montessori, our educators maintain attentive observation, ongoing communication with families, and participate in regular training to support the prevention and early identification of concerns.

Failure to report is an offence under legislation. All reports made in good faith are protected by law. Where a concern involves a staff member, Tiffin Bay Montessori, will follow all regulatory requirements, including submitting a serious occurrence report to the Ministry of Education within the required 24 hours timeframe.

Internal Staff Procedure:

Any staff member who has reasonable grounds to suspect that a child is in need of protection must immediately report their concern directly to a Children's Aid Society, inform the Supervisor/Director, document the concern, and follow all required reporting and serious occurrence procedures.

Confidentiality

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we are committed to protecting the privacy and dignity of all children, families, educators, and community members. All personal information, concerns, and matters related to the centre are treated with the highest level of confidentiality and respect.

Information is shared only with those who require it to support the care, safety, and well-being of the child, or as required by law. In certain circumstances, information may be disclosed to appropriate authorities, including the Ministry of Education, the College of Early Childhood Educators, law enforcement, or a Children's Aid Society.

Guided by the principles of Maria Montessori, our educators uphold professionalism, discretion, and respect in all interactions, ensuring that trust is maintained within our community.

Tuition

1. Tuition is due on the fourth day of each month via pre-authorized debit (PAD) or cheque. Outstanding charges for late pick-up or extended hours will be added to next month's invoice.

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2. As participants in the CWELCC system (effective March 2026 Tiffin Bay Montessori is enrolled in the Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) system. Parent fees are reduced in accordance with provincial guidelines for eligible children. All fee reductions are subject to eligibility and continued government funding. Non-CWELCC rates apply for children 6-12 (if offered).

Program Options & Fees

Tiffin Bay Montessori operates Monday to Friday from 7:45 AM to 5:30 PM, offering full-time programs designed to support each child's development within a prepared Montessori environment.

Base Fees (Prior to CWELCC Reduction)

Toddler Program (18 months to 30 months)

- 5 days per week (Monday to Friday)
- \$55.00 per day

Preschool/Casa Program (30 months to 5 years)

- 5 days per week (Monday to Friday)
- \$52.00 per day

CWELCC Fee Reduction

Tiffin Bay Montessori participates in the Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) system.

For eligible children under the age of 6, the current parent fee is \$22.00 per day in accordance with CWELCC guidelines.

Fees are subject to change in accordance with updates to CWELCC funding, government policy, or direction from the County of Simcoe. Any changes will be communicated to families in advance.

Non-Base Fees

The following fees are not included in CWELCC base fees:

- NSF Fee: \$45.00
- Late Pick-Up Fee: \$2.00 per minute after closing

Fee Payment Schedule and Method

Tuition fees are due on the fourth (4th) day of each month.

Fees are payable through pre-authorized debit (PAD) or post-dated cheque, as arranged during enrollment.

Failure to make payment by the due date may result in administrative charges or discharge from the program, as outlined in the Financial Policies section.

Financial Policies

Fee Payment & Deposit

To secure a child's space, a deposit equivalent to up to four (4) weeks of the CWELCC-approved parent fee is required.

This deposit:

- Is based on the reduced CWELCC daily fee
- Will be applied toward the child's final four (4) weeks of care, provided proper written notice is given
- Is non-refundable except where required by applicable legislation

Tuition fees are due monthly and are payable via pre-authorized debit (PAD) or approved payment method.

Parents are required to pay for any days off, vacation days, sick days, statutory holidays, the scheduled two-week closure in December, the annual Professional Development (PD) Day held on the Friday prior to Labour Day, and any unforeseen closure days (inclement weather, etc.).

Tiffin Bay Montessori participates in the Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) system. Fees may be reduced in accordance with CWELCC guidelines; however, all reduced fees remain subject to eligibility, enrollment status, and ongoing government funding. Any changes to CWELCC funding or eligibility may result in adjustments to parent fees, with notice provided.

Refunds, Deposits, and Withdrawal

Tiffin Bay Montessori operates on a space-based enrollment model. Fees are charged based on enrollment and not attendance.

The following conditions apply:

- There are no registration fees charged by the centre
- The deposit is non-refundable and will be applied toward the final four (4) weeks of care, provided proper written notice is given
- A minimum of four (4) weeks written notice is required to withdraw a child from the program

Where proper notice is provided:

- The deposit will be applied to the final four (4) weeks of care
- No refunds will be issued for unused days or partial months

Where proper notice is NOT provided:

- The deposit will be forfeited and/or applied toward fees in lieu of notice

No refunds or credits will be provided for:

- Partial months of attendance
- Absences, illness, or vacation
- Statutory holidays or scheduled closures

All fees remain payable during the notice period regardless of attendance.

Where a parent/guardian provides more than the required four (4) weeks written notice, any prepaid fees beyond the required notice period will be refunded.

Uniform Policy

Beginning September 2026, Tiffin Bay Montessori will introduce a school uniform program to support a consistent, cohesive, and respectful learning environment.

Families are encouraged to dress children in clothing that aligns with the centre's uniform standard, consisting of:

- Navy blue bottoms (e.g., pants, shorts, skirts), provided by families
- A top that reflects the Tiffin Bay Montessori identity, including neutral or centre-branded options

To support consistency, Tiffin Bay Montessori branded shirts ("camisas") featuring the centre's logo will be made available for purchase through the centre at an approximate cost of \$25 per item.

While families are encouraged to use branded items to promote a unified appearance, the purchase of centre-issued uniform items is optional.

Families may choose to source comparable clothing items independently, provided they align with the general colour and style expectations of the centre.

No child will be excluded from participation in the program due to the absence of a branded uniform item.

Uniform items are not considered a required program fee and are not a condition of enrollment.

Holidays and Centre Closures

Tiffin Bay Montessori will be closed on the following statutory holidays and scheduled closure days:

- **January:** includes the 2 weeks shut down
- **February:** Family Day
- **April:** Good Friday & Easter Monday
- **May:** Victoria Day
- **July:** Canada Day
- **August:** Civic Holiday
- **September:** Labour Day
- **October:** Thanksgiving Day
- **December 2026:** Two-week holiday closure during the Christmas season (Dec 21st to Jan 4th, 2027)
- **Professional Development (PD) Day:**
Tiffin Bay Montessori will be closed on **Friday, September 4, 2026** (the Friday prior to Labour Day) for staff professional development.

Withdrawal Policy

Parents/guardians may withdraw their child from the program by providing a minimum of four (4) weeks written notice to the centre.

Where sufficient notice is not provided, fees in lieu of notice will be charged or deducted from the deposit.

All outstanding fees must be paid in full prior to the child's final day of attendance.

Receipts

Income tax receipts will be issued annually in February.

Child Care Funding & Fee Support

Tiffin Bay Montessori participates in the **Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC)** system, which provides reduced child care fees for eligible families. Daily fees may be significantly lowered in accordance with CWELCC guidelines; however, all reductions are subject to eligibility, enrollment status, and ongoing government funding. Any changes to funding may result in adjustments to parent fees, with notice provided.

In addition to CWELCC, families residing in Simcoe County who require further financial assistance may apply for the **Child Care Fee Subsidy** program. Eligibility and subsidy amounts are determined by Simcoe County.

For more information or to apply for fee subsidy, please visit www.simcoe.ca or contact Simcoe County at **705-722-3132**.

Registration & Enrollment

When a space becomes available, Tiffin Bay Montessori will contact families using the contact information provided.

Families will be given a specified period of time to accept the offered space. Acceptance must be confirmed in writing.

Upon acceptance of a space, a deposit is required within the timeframe outlined by the centre to secure enrollment. Failure to submit the deposit within the required timeframe may result in the space being offered to another family.

Enrollment is confirmed only upon receipt of all required documentation, including but not limited to completed registration forms, emergency contact information, and all health and immunization documentation in accordance with Simcoe Muskoka District Health Unit requirements.

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All required documentation must be submitted and verified prior to the child's first day of attendance. Children will not be permitted to attend the program until all required documentation has been received and approved.

Tiffin Bay Montessori reserves the right to withdraw or defer enrollment if required documentation is not provided in accordance with centre policies and regulatory requirements.

Wait List Policy and Procedures

Purpose

Tiffin Bay Montessori School maintains a waiting list for families who wish to enroll their children in our programs when spaces are not immediately available. This policy ensures that our waitlist procedures are **transparent, fair, and compliant** with the **Ontario Ministry of Education** and **Simcoe County** requirements under the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014 (CCEYA)*..

Tiffin Bay Montessori School will:

- Maintain an accurate, confidential waiting list for all interested families;
- Ensure that no fee is charged to be placed on the waiting list;
- Offer equal access to all applicants regardless of race, ethnicity, gender, ability, or family status;
- Manage admissions in a transparent and consistent manner; and
- Provide families with their child's position on the waiting list upon request

Policy

General

- **Tiffin Bay Montessori School** will strive to accommodate all requests for the registration of a child in its Montessori and early learning programs.
- Where the maximum licensed capacity of a classroom or age group has been reached and spaces are unavailable for new children to be enrolled, the waiting list procedures set out below will be followed.
- **No fee** will be charged to parents/guardians for placing a child on the waiting list.
- Families will be advised that placement on the waiting list **does not guarantee a space** in the program but ensures fair consideration as spaces become available.

Policy Statement

☐ The **School Supervisor** will be responsible for managing and maintaining the waiting list in accordance with this policy.

☐ The waiting list will be **maintained in chronological order** based on the date the completed registration request is received.

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☐ The waiting list will be managed in a **transparent and fair** manner that protects the **confidentiality and privacy** of all applicants.

☐ Families may **request information** about their child's position on the waiting list at any time. Only general position information (e.g., "within the top three for the Casa program") will be shared.

☐ The waiting list will be **updated regularly** to reflect changes in enrollment, withdrawals, and family requests for removal.

☐ The waiting list will be **reviewed quarterly** by the Administrator to ensure accuracy and compliance with the *Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014* (CCEYA) and Simcoe County requirements.

Procedures

Adding a Child to the Waiting List

- Families may request to be placed on the waiting list by completing the **Waitlist Application Form** available on the school's website or by contacting the office.
- No payment or deposit is required to join the list.
- The date the completed application is received determines the child's position on the waiting list.

b. Priority Placement

Priority may be given in the following order:

1. Currently enrolled children moving to the next age group.
2. Siblings of currently enrolled children.
3. Children of staff members.
4. Families previously enrolled with Tiffin Bay Montessori School.
5. All other applicants in the order the application was received.

Exceptions to this order may apply if required to maintain program balance or to accommodate equity, diversity, and inclusion goals.

c. Notification of Space Availability

- When space becomes available, families will be contacted by phone and/or email.
- Families will be given **48 hours** to confirm acceptance of the space.
- If no response is received within that time frame, the next family on the list will be contacted.
- Declining the offered space does not remove the family from the waiting list unless they request removal.

d. Access to Waiting List Information

- Families may request information about their current position on the waiting list by contacting the school administrator.
- To protect privacy, only relative position (e.g., “among the top five applicants”) will be shared—specific names or details of other applicants will not be disclosed.

e. Record Keeping and Privacy

- The waiting list will be maintained securely in accordance with the **Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA)**.
 - Information collected will be used solely for enrollment and program administration purposes.
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4. Transparency and Review

- This policy will be made available to all families and posted on the school’s website.
 - The school will review and update this policy annually or as required by legislative or procedural changes from the Ministry of Education or Simcoe County.
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Discharge

Tiffin Bay Montessori reserves the right to discharge a child from the program under the following circumstances:

- Non-payment of fees
- Failure to comply with centre policies and procedures
- Behavior that poses a safety risk to the child, other children, or staff
- Where continued enrollment is not in the best interest of the child or the program

Where possible, reasonable notice will be provided to families. In situations involving immediate safety concerns, discharge may occur without notice.

The centre will make reasonable efforts to support transition where appropriate.

Suspension & Discharge Policy

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, the safety and well-being of all children is our highest priority. Guided by the philosophy of Maria Montessori, we work collaboratively with families to support children through observation, guidance, and appropriate interventions.

Where behavior places a child or others at risk, we will make every effort to work with available resources, including external professionals (e.g., resource consultants), with parent/guardian consent. If consent is not provided, the centre will continue to follow the steps outlined below.

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Suspension is a last resort and requires approval from the Director and ownership.

Progressive Steps:

- 1-day suspension with documentation and parent meeting
- 3-day suspension with documentation and follow-up meeting
- 7-day suspension with documentation, Ministry notification, and required re-entry meeting

If behavior does not improve, the child may be discharged with no re-admittance. If another child's safety is at immediate risk, the centre may proceed directly to termination of care.

If all efforts have been exhausted, Tiffin Bay Montessori may determine that continued enrollment is not in the best interest of the child or group. A minimum of two (2) weeks written notice will be provided, and reasonable efforts will be made to support transition to alternate care.

Admission and Discharge Policy

Tiffin Bay Montessori is committed to providing clear, transparent, and fair processes for the admission, enrollment, withdrawal, and discharge of children in accordance with the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA).

Admission

Children are admitted to Tiffin Bay Montessori based on program availability, age group placement, and completion of all required documentation.

Families must submit a completed Registration Package prior to the child's start date, including:

- Enrollment application form
- Emergency contact information
- Immunization records or exemption documentation
- Medical and dietary information (if applicable)
- Payment registration and deposit

Enrollment is conditional upon receipt of all required documentation and approvals.

Admission Procedures

As Midland's first and only Montessori school, Tiffin Bay Montessori is proud to be opening its doors to families in our community. As a new centre, our focus is on establishing a calm, consistent, and well-prepared environment that supports a smooth and successful transition for all children.

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Tiffin Bay Montessori welcomes families to visit our school and learn more about our Montessori program. Tours are offered to prospective families, providing an opportunity to explore the classrooms, meet educators, review daily routines, and discuss any questions.

Families who are interested in enrolling will receive a **Parent Handbook and Registration Package** during their visit.

Registration Requirements

A completed Registration Package must be submitted prior to the child's first day of attendance and includes:

- Completed and signed Application for Enrollment
- Child's name, date of birth, and home address
- Parent/guardian names, addresses, and contact information
- Emergency contact details
- Authorized pick-up persons
- Admission and anticipated discharge dates
- Immunization record or required exemption documentation
- Medical history, including communicable diseases and conditions requiring attention
- Any symptoms indicative of ill health
- Individualized plans (if applicable)
- Written authorization for any medication or medical treatment
- Written instructions regarding diet, rest, or physical activity, including the **"All About Me"** form
- Physician recommendations regarding sleep arrangements (if applicable)
- Any additional information required to support the child's care

Parents/guardians are also required to complete payment registration through the centre's authorized debit system prior to the child's start date.

Enrollment Process

Families interested in enrolling at Tiffin Bay Montessori are invited to attend an initial visit. During this visit, a tour of the centre will be provided, allowing families to explore the classrooms, meet educators, review the program and daily routines, and discuss any questions or considerations. A Parent Handbook and Registration Package will be provided at this time.

The completed Registration Package, including all required forms, up-to-date immunization records, and payment agreement, must be submitted prior to the child's first day of attendance.

To support a smooth transition, Tiffin Bay Montessori may offer opportunities for children to become familiar with the environment, educators, and daily routine prior to their start date. Transition approaches will be guided by educators in collaboration with families to ensure each child is supported in a calm and consistent manner.

Only children with fully completed registration packages, including all required documentation and approvals, will be permitted to begin attendance in the program.

At enrollment, parents/guardians must provide at least two emergency contact as part of the Registration Package and acknowledge that this information will be accessible to authorized staff for safety purposes.

Parents are responsible for ensuring all contact information is accurate and kept up to date.

Safe Arrival and Dismissal Policy and Procedures

Date Policy and Procedures Established: March 14, 2026

Date Policy and Procedures Updated: March 16, 2026

Purpose

This policy and the procedures within support the **safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care** at Tiffin Bay Montessori.

This policy provides staff, students, and volunteers with a clear understanding of their roles and responsibilities for ensuring the safe arrival and dismissal of children, including:

- steps to take when a child does not arrive at the childcare centre as expected
- steps to follow to ensure the safe dismissal of children

This policy fulfills the obligations set out under **Ontario Regulation 137/15 under the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA)**.

Policy General

Tiffin Bay Montessori will ensure that any child receiving care at the centre is **only released to:**

- the child's **parent or guardian**, or
- an **individual authorized in writing by the parent or guardian**

Children will **not be released without supervision** unless written authorization is provided by the parent/guardian and approved by the centre supervisor.

Where a child does **not arrive as expected** or is **not picked up as expected**, staff must follow the procedures outlined in this policy.

Procedures

Accepting a Child into Care

When accepting a child into care during drop-off, program staff must:

1. Greet the parent/guardian and child.
2. Ask the parent/guardian if there are any changes to pick-up procedures.
3. Confirm that any alternate pick-up person is listed on the child's authorized pick-up list.
4. Document any changes to dismissal instructions in the **daily written record**.
5. **Sign the child in on the classroom attendance record.**

Safe Arrival Monitoring

Tiffin Bay Montessori operates a **Safe Arrival Check at 9:30 AM daily**.

If a Child Has Not Arrived by 9:30 AM

If a child has not arrived at the centre and the parent/guardian has **not communicated the absence**, the following procedure will occur:

1. Classroom staff notify the **Centre Supervisor**.
2. The **Supervisor will contact the parent/guardian by phone**.
3. If the parent cannot be reached:
 - a voicemail will be left
 - additional contact attempts may be made
4. Staff may also contact **authorized emergency contacts** if necessary.

Once the absence has been confirmed:

- the absence will be documented in the **attendance record**
- any additional notes will be recorded in the **daily written record**

Parents are expected to **notify the centre if their child will be absent or arriving late**.

Releasing a Child from Care

Children will only be released to:

- their **parent/guardian**
- or an **authorized individual listed in the child's file**

If staff do not recognize the individual picking up the child:

1. Staff will request **photo identification**.
2. Staff will verify that the person is listed on the child's **authorized pick-up list**.

If authorization cannot be confirmed, **the child will not be released**.

Safe Dismissal Procedures

Tiffin Bay Montessori closes at **5:30 PM**.

Parents must notify the centre **in advance** if they will be late picking up their child.

Late Pick-Up Procedure

If a child has not been picked up and **no communication has been received**, the following steps will occur.

5:35 PM – Initial Contact

At **5:35 PM**, staff will:

- contact the **parent/guardian by phone**
- leave a message if necessary
- document the attempt

Parents are expected to **immediately contact the centre**.

5 Minutes After First Call

If staff **cannot reach the parent**, staff will:

- call the **next authorized emergency contact listed on the child's file**

10 Minutes After First Call

If staff cannot reach **any authorized contact**, staff will:

- continue attempts to contact parents and emergency contacts

- document all contact attempts

Escalation Procedure

If staff are **unable to reach any authorized person**, the following steps will occur:

1. The **Supervisor will contact the local Children's Aid Society (CAS)** for guidance.
2. Staff will follow the direction provided by CAS.
3. The incident will be documented.
4. A **Serious Occurrence Report** will be completed as required under the **CCEYA**.

While Waiting for Pick-Up

During this time:

- the child will remain supervised by staff
- the child will be offered comfort, activities, and reassurance
- the child will **never be left alone**

Two staff members will remain on site whenever possible until the situation is resolved.

Documentation

All situations involving:

- late pick-ups
- inability to reach parents
- CAS contact
- unusual dismissal situations

must be **fully documented** in:

- the **daily written record**
- incident reports where required
- **Serious Occurrence reporting system**, if applicable.

Glossary

Authorized Individual

A person listed in writing by the parent/guardian who is permitted to pick up the child.

Parent/Guardian

A person having lawful custody of a child or a person who has demonstrated a settled intention to treat a child as a member of their family.

Licensee

The corporation or individual responsible for the operation of the licensed child care centre.

Absence Policy

Tiffin Bay Montessori understands that children may be absent due to illness, vacation, or other reasons. Parents/guardians are required to notify the centre when their child will be absent.

For families receiving fee subsidy through Simcoe County, allowable absence days are determined by Children's Services. If the number of permitted absence days is exceeded, parents/guardians may be responsible for paying the full fee for additional days, in accordance with subsidy guidelines.

Families paying full fees are not limited in the number of absence days; however, regular fees remain payable regardless of attendance.

For more information regarding absence policies or appeals, families may contact their Children's Services Caseworker or Simcoe County.

Divorced Parents

When divorced parents have a custody agreement, the noncustodial parent may pick up the child unless a court order specifies otherwise.

Transportation

Parents are responsible for transporting children to and from school, arriving and departing promptly. Call the school if an emergency delays you.

Illness

1. Keep children home if ill until symptoms are resolved. Immediately inform us of communicable diseases (e.g., chicken pox, conjunctivitis).
2. Children with fever must be fever-free for 24 hours fever free from the last fever, and those with diarrhea/vomiting symptom-free for 48 hours before returning. Ill children will be sent home.
3. If a child becomes ill at school, parents will be notified, and the child is isolated until picked up.
4. Update emergency contacts as needed. Ill children must be picked up promptly due to limited space/staff. Montessori Learning Centre.

Medication Policy

Tiffin Bay Montessori provides clear procedures for the safe administration of medication and appropriate record-keeping by staff.

For the purpose of this policy, “medication” refers to any product with a Drug Identification Number (DIN), including both:

- **Prescription medication** (for acute or ongoing treatment)
- **Non-prescription (over the counter) medication** used for acute or symptomatic treatment

Items such as sunscreen, lotion, lip balm, insect repellent, hand sanitizer, and diaper cream are not considered medication unless used for medical treatment.

To support the health, safety, and well-being of all children, Tiffin Bay Montessori ensures that medications are:

- Provided by parents/guardians with clear instructions
- Stored securely and in accordance with label directions
- Administered safely to prevent errors or accidental ingestion
- Available for immediate use in emergency situations (e.g., allergy or asthma medication)

Parents/guardians are encouraged to administer medication at home whenever possible. Medication will only be administered at the centre when:

- Written authorization is provided by the parent/guardian
- Medication is in its original container with a clear label (child’s name, dosage, instructions)
- For non-prescription medication, a physician’s note is provided outlining when and how it should be administered

The **Authorization for Medication Administration Form** must be completed and will be reviewed regularly with parents/guardians to ensure accuracy of dosage and instructions. All administration of medication will be documented in the child’s records.

Medication must be labeled with the child’s name, delivered to the office with written physician instructions and parental permission.

Individual Medical Plan

Tiffin Bay Montessori ensures that any child or staff member with medical needs has an individualized medical plan developed in accordance with Ministry guidelines.

Each plan is created in consultation with the child’s parent/guardian and any relevant regulated health professional. The completed plan will be maintained in the child’s file and accessible within classroom emergency binders.

Individual Medical Plans include:

- Measures to reduce the risk of exposure to triggers or conditions that may cause a medical emergency
- A description of any medical devices used by the child, along with instructions for use
- Clear procedures to be followed in the event of an allergic reaction or other medical emergency
- A description of supports provided to the child while in care
- Additional procedures for emergencies, including evacuations and off-site activities

All staff, students, and volunteers will review and sign off on Individual Medical Plans annually. Any updates to the plan will be communicated, reviewed, and re-signed as required.

Allergies & Anaphylaxis Policy

Allergies

Tiffin Bay Montessori is a **nut-free environment** to support the safety and well-being of all children. All allergies, food restrictions, and medical conditions must be clearly documented in the Registration Package and discussed with the Director prior to the child's start date.

For celebrations, families may provide simple, nutritious, **nut-free, store-bought items**, which must be clearly labeled. Please notify educators in advance.

Where food is brought from home, parents/guardians must:

- Ensure all food is clearly labeled with the child's full name
- Provide a list of ingredients with the food
- Follow all centre guidelines regarding allergens

If food is not properly labeled or does not meet centre requirements, it will not be served, and an alternative will be provided.

Anaphylaxis

Anaphylaxis is a serious, potentially life-threatening allergic reaction. Tiffin Bay Montessori is committed to minimizing risk and ensuring all staff are trained to respond quickly and effectively.

An **Individual Medical Plan** will be developed in collaboration with parents/guardians and, where applicable, healthcare professionals. This plan outlines triggers, symptoms, and emergency procedures.

Parent/Guardian Responsibilities:

- Provide a current, unexpired EpiPen
- Ensure all medical and emergency forms are completed and up to date

Centre Responsibilities:

- Ensure all staff are trained in recognizing symptoms and administering emergency medication
- Keep emergency medication accessible at all times and with the child during all activities
- Maintain and post Individual Medical Plans in classrooms and emergency binders
- Document all medication administration and ensure staff review and sign off on plans

In the Event of an Anaphylactic Reaction:

- Emergency medication (EpiPen) will be administered immediately
- **911 will be called**, and the child will be transported to the hospital
- Parents/guardians will be notified immediately
- A serious occurrence report will be filed with the Ministry of Education

Immunization Requirements

Tiffin Bay Montessori requires all children to have up-to-date immunization records in accordance with public health regulations. Parents/guardians must provide current immunization documentation prior to enrollment and ensure records remain updated.

If a child is not immunized, one of the following must be provided:

- A written medical exemption from a qualified medical practitioner outlining the medical reason
- **or**
- A completed Immunization Exemption Form based on conscience or religious belief

In the event of a communicable disease outbreak, children who are not adequately immunized may be excluded from the program until the risk has passed or immunization requirements are met.

Illness & Exclusion Policy

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, the health and well-being of all children is a shared responsibility. Daily health observations are conducted upon arrival to ensure children are well enough to participate in the program.

Parents/guardians are asked to keep children at home if they are unwell or showing symptoms of illness, including but not limited to:

- Fever (38°C or higher)
- Vomiting or diarrhea
- Unexplained rash
- Discharge from eyes or ears
- Persistent cough
- Communicable illness or condition (e.g., head lice)

Children must remain home until they are symptom-free for at least **24 hours** or are well enough to fully participate in the program. Children may be sent home if symptoms develop during the day.

Tiffin Bay Montessori follows guidance from the Simcoe Muskoka District Health Unit regarding exclusion periods and outbreak management. Parents/guardians are required to inform the centre of any communicable illness.

In the event of an outbreak, enhanced health and safety measures will be implemented, and families must follow all public health direction. Illness policies may be adjusted during outbreaks, and children may be required to remain home for **48 hours symptom-free** or as directed by Public Health.

Health & Safety Practices

Educators follow daily cleaning, sanitization, and infection control practices to support a healthy environment. Families are encouraged to support these efforts by practicing good hygiene and keeping children home when unwell.

Notices of illnesses or outbreaks will be communicated in accordance with Public Health guidelines.

Rest Time

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, toddlers and preschool children are provided with a daily rest period of up to **two hours** to support their health and well-being.

Children rest on individual cots (with parent/guardian consent on file). Rest routines are developed in consultation with families to reflect each child's individual needs.

Children who do not sleep are guided to engage in quiet Montessori work or calm activities, either on their cot or in a designated area, in a respectful and peaceful environment.

Educators remain actively present during rest time and conduct regular visual checks to ensure the safety and comfort of all children. When multiple staff are present, responsibilities are assigned to maintain consistent supervision.

Emergency Medical Treatment

In emergencies requiring immediate care, we'll obtain treatment and notify parents. A signed Consent Form (filed at school) authorizes this.

Accidents, Incidents & Injury While in Care

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, children are supervised at all times. As children explore and develop new skills, minor accidents may occur.

If a child is injured while in care, educators will provide immediate first aid. If further medical attention is required, parents/guardians or emergency contacts will be notified. In serious situations, emergency services (911) will be contacted, and the child may be transported to the nearest hospital.

An incident report will be completed for all accidents or injuries. Parents/guardians are required to review and sign the report, and a copy will be provided, with another copy retained in the child's file.

If a child experiences an injury outside of the centre, parents/guardians must inform staff upon arrival so the information can be documented accordingly.

Minor Accidents: Staff administer first aid, file an accident report (one copy to parent, one to child's file).

Serious Accidents: Child is taken to the office, then to the emergency room via ambulance with a teacher; parents are notified of the hospital.

Reporting of Suspected Child Abuse and/or Neglect

Staff will report suspected abuse/neglect to the Simcoe County Children's Aid Society per the Child Abuse Reporting Act.

Observations and Conferences

1. Parents may observe at any time but should schedule to avoid upsetting children expecting to leave. Unannounced visits may not permit leaving an upset child.
2. Parent-Teacher conferences occur once a yearly (fall) or by request with an appointment.

Approach to Discipline

Code of Behavior: Positive Approaches to Misbehavior

Montessori fosters self-discipline through focus and independent learning. Misbehaviors are met with:

- Discussing actions, not personality.
- Avoiding stereotypes.
- Using careful physical restraint (e.g., bear hug) if a child is out of control.
- Encouraging emotional expression with active listening.
- Maintaining harmony with gentle tones, avoiding harshness.
- Offering a peace corner for reflection.

Inner Discipline

Self-discipline is nurtured via an orderly environment, freedom to choose capable work, and mixed-age modeling (younger learn from older, older reinforce by helping).

Clothing & Personal Belongings

Each child is provided with a personal cubby to store outdoor clothing, shoes, and extra items. Parents/guardians are asked to provide a complete change of clothing to support independence and manage toileting or spill-related accidents.

All clothing and personal belongings must be clearly labeled to help prevent loss or mix-ups. Please avoid sending valuables, as Tiffin Bay Montessori is not responsible for lost or missing items.

A designated lost and found area will be available for any misplaced belongings. Wear comfortable, washable clothes and sturdy shoes, easy for children to manage. Provide labeled shoes, a full change (shirt, pants, underwear, socks) and, in winter, extra hat, scarf, mittens. Soiled clothing goes home daily.

Nutrition

Nutritious snacks are provided twice daily, along with a full-day lunch included in tuition. In keeping with the Montessori philosophy, we promote independence during mealtimes—children are encouraged to participate in preparing their own snacks, serving themselves, and developing practical life skills in a safe and supportive environment.

Personal Items

In keeping with the Montessori environment, toys from home are not permitted as they may disrupt the classroom. A small comfort item (such as a stuffed toy) may be brought to support a child's transition. Tiffin Bay Montessori is not responsible for lost or damaged items.

Toys

No toys from home are allowed, you can bring a stuffy or a soothing belonging to help the child transitioning. We're not responsible for lost/broken toys.

Birthdays & Celebrations

Birthdays are honored in a meaningful way aligned with Montessori philosophy through a **"Birthday Walk Around the World"**, celebrating each child's growth and journey. If families wish to bring a simple, nutritious treat, please coordinate with the educator in advance.

Community Experiences (field trips)

Community-based experiences (e.g., seasonal outings such as pumpkin patches, maple sugar activities, and Olympic-style events) are incorporated to enrich the Montessori curriculum. Families may be invited to participate where appropriate.

Participation requires prior parental consent, and any applicable fees will be communicated in advance. Up-to-date health and emergency information must be on file for all participating children.

Community Walks & Off-Site Experiences

Tiffin Bay Montessori values connection to the local community and incorporates meaningful experiences such as neighborhood walks and nature-based outings into the program.

Families will be informed of planned walks through classroom programming, and written parental consent is required for participation.

Occasionally, older children may participate in off-site experiences. Families will be notified in advance and provided with detailed information and consent forms prior to participation.

We welcome families to share ideas and community opportunities that may enrich the children's learning experiences.

Tiffin Bay Montessori School



Release of Liability and Indemnity

The Applicant hereby acknowledges and agrees to abide by all policies, procedures, and guidelines established by Tiffin Bay Montessori Child Care Centre for the safety, well-being, and orderly operation of the program.

The Applicant understands that participation in childcare programming involves inherent risks associated with normal daily activities, both indoors and outdoors.

To the fullest extent permitted by law, the Applicant agrees to release and hold harmless Tiffin Bay Montessori Child Care Centre, its owners, directors, employees, educators, and authorized representatives from any and all claims, demands, damages, or liability arising from any injury, loss, or incident involving their child while participating in the program, except where such liability results from negligence or failure to comply with applicable legislation.

I, _____ (Name), the _____ (Relationship) of the Applicant, hereby consent to the above and agree to indemnify and save harmless Tiffin Bay Montessori Child Care Centre, its owners, staff, and representatives from any claims or demands made on behalf of the Applicant, except where prohibited by law.

Office Use Only

Please Circle: NEW RENEWAL

Program Name: _____

Total Fees: _____

Method of Payment: _____

Renewal Date: _____

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have executed this Agreement:

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____

Date: _____

Authorized Representative (Tiffin Bay Montessori): _____

Date: _____

Outdoor Play

In accordance with the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA), children at Tiffin Bay Montessori participate in a minimum of **two hours of outdoor play daily**, weather permitting.

Tiffin Bay Montessori School



Outdoor time is an essential part of the Montessori environment, offering opportunities for exploration, movement, and connection with nature. Both planned and spontaneous experiences support children's physical, social, and cognitive development.

Children must be dressed appropriately for all weather conditions to fully participate in outdoor play. Parents/guardians are responsible for providing suitable clothing and footwear throughout the year.

Outdoor time may be adjusted based on weather conditions to ensure children remain safe, comfortable, and engaged. Educators monitor children closely and adapt activities accordingly.

Tiffin Bay Montessori promotes sun safety practices. Families are encouraged to provide sunscreen and protective clothing (e.g., hats). Educators will assist with application as needed prior to outdoor play. Drinking water is available and offered regularly.

Photos & Communication

To protect the privacy and dignity of all children, the use of personal cell phones or cameras by parents, visitors, students, or volunteers is not permitted within Tiffin Bay Montessori.

The centre may capture photos of children using authorized devices for the purpose of documenting learning, sharing experiences, and supporting communication with families. These photos may be shared through secure parent communication platforms and, where consent is provided, on Tiffin Bay Montessori's website or social media channels.

Parent/guardian consent for photography and media use is obtained at the time of enrollment and may be updated at any time.

From time to time, families may also receive individual photos highlighting their child's participation, development, and learning within the Montessori environment.

Privacy of Others

Families are respectfully asked not to photograph, record, or share images of any child other than their own while at the centre or during any Tiffin Bay Montessori events, in order to protect the privacy of all children and families.

Freedom of Information & Protection of Privacy

Tiffin Bay Montessori School is committed to protecting the privacy and confidentiality of all children and families. Personal information is collected for the purpose of providing safe, effective childcare services and maintaining required records in accordance with applicable legislation.

Information collected may include:

- Parent/guardian name and contact information
- Child's name, date of birth, and enrollment details
- Immunization records and health information
- Emergency contact information
- Billing and account information
- Any additional information necessary to support the child's care and well-being

All personal information is securely stored and accessed only by authorized staff. Information will only be used, disclosed, or shared when required to support the child's care or as required by law (e.g., Ministry of Education, public health authorities, or Children's Aid Society).

Parents/guardians are asked to review and sign the accompanying **Acknowledgment and Consent Form** confirming their understanding and consent to the collection, use, and disclosure of personal information as outlined above.

Social Media Disclaimer

Any photos or videos shared with families are intended for personal use only. Families are asked not to post or share images of other children, staff, or the centre environment on social media or other public platforms without prior written consent from Tiffin Bay Montessori.

Students & Volunteers

Tiffin Bay Montessori supports student placements and volunteers enrolled in Early Childhood Education programs through approved partnerships. These opportunities allow individuals to observe, learn, and practice skills within an authentic Montessori environment while contributing positively to the classroom community.

Students and volunteers are not counted in staff-to-child ratios and are never left unsupervised with children. They are guided and supported by qualified educators at all times.

Prior to beginning their placement, all students and volunteers must provide:

- A valid Police Vulnerable Sector Check
- Current First Aid and CPR certification
- A health assessment, where required
- Signed acknowledgment of all Tiffin Bay Montessori policies and procedures

Tiffin Bay Montessori School



Through mentorship and collaboration, our educators support the development of future professionals while maintaining a safe, respectful, and high-quality learning environment for all children.

A Respectful Environment

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we are committed to fostering a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment for all children, families, educators, and community members. We uphold a high standard of positive interactions, communication, and role modelling in alignment with Montessori principles. Harassment, discrimination, or disrespectful behavior will not be tolerated under any circumstances.

All individuals entering the centre are expected to contribute to a respectful and supportive atmosphere. If at any time a parent/guardian, staff member, or visitor feels uncomfortable, threatened, or disrespected, they may end the interaction and report the concern to the Director or licensee.

Tiffin Bay Montessori will address all concerns in a fair, impartial, and confidential manner. Where necessary, external agencies may be contacted to support resolution. Information will only be disclosed when required by law (e.g., Ministry of Education, College of Early Childhood Educators, law enforcement, or Children's Aid Society).

Failure to adhere to these expectations may result in restricted or denied access to the centre.

Inclement Weather Closures

In the event of severe weather or local school closures, Tiffin Bay Montessori may also close for the safety of children and staff.

Families will be notified of closures via phone, email, parent communication app, or other centre communication channels. If a closure occurs during operating hours, parents/guardians will be contacted to arrange prompt pick-up of their child.

Please note that fees remain payable for days closed due to inclement weather.

Emergency Management

At **Tiffin Bay Montessori School, 788 Yonge Street, Midland**, the safety and well-being of all children, staff, and visitors is our highest priority. A comprehensive Emergency Management Policy is in place and aligns with Ontario Regulation 137/15 and Montessori principles of calm, preparedness, and guided response.

All staff are trained in emergency procedures and are responsible for responding promptly while maintaining a safe, structured, and supportive environment for children.

Emergency Procedures Include:

- Clearly defined staff roles and responsibilities
- Step-by-step response procedures for emergency situations
- Ongoing supervision and regular headcounts of all children
- Support for children with medical or individual needs through established plans
- Immediate contact with emergency services (911) when required
- Ongoing communication with parents/guardians
- Post-incident documentation, review, and recovery procedures

In the event of an evacuation, children will be safely relocated to our designated meeting location:
Little Lake Park

Parents/guardians will be notified as soon as possible using the contact information on file, including phone, email, or communication through the **ClassDojo app**. Updates will be provided until the situation is resolved.

Following any emergency, Tiffin Bay Montessori will support children and staff through a calm and respectful transition back to routine, including emotional support where needed.

Regular emergency drills are conducted, and emergency kits are maintained and accessible at all times.

Parent Notification Policy

Tiffin Bay Montessori is committed to maintaining open, timely, and transparent communication with parents and guardians regarding all matters affecting their child and the operation of the centre.

Parents/guardians will be notified as soon as possible in the event of any situation that may impact their child's health, safety, or well-being, or the normal operation of the centre.

Notification may occur in the following circumstances, including but not limited to:

- Illness or injury involving a child
- Emergency situations or evacuations
- Unexpected centre closures (e.g., weather, utilities, or other emergencies)
- Changes to program operations or schedules
- Outbreaks or public health concerns
- Incidents involving the safety or well-being of children

Methods of Communication

Tiffin Bay Montessori may use one or more of the following methods to communicate with parents/guardians:

- Phone call
- Email
- Written notice
- Parent communication applications (e.g. Dojo)
- In-person communication at drop-off or pick-up

In emergency situations, every effort will be made to contact parents/guardians directly using the contact information on file.

Parents/guardians are responsible for ensuring that all contact information remains current and accurate at all times.

Where required, written documentation of incidents or notifications will be maintained in accordance with the Child Care and Early Years Act (CCEYA).

Montessori Philosophy & the Classroom

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, our classrooms are thoughtfully prepared to reflect the philosophy of Maria Montessori, where children are respected as capable, independent individuals.

Our environment fosters:

- Respect for each child as a competent and valued member of the community
- Clear and consistent expectations that support independence and responsibility
- Opportunities for children to construct knowledge through exploration and hands-on experiences
- Activities that align with developmental needs and offer sensorial, aesthetic, and cultural enrichment
- Educators who act as guides, observing and supporting each child while following the Montessori principle of “follow the child”

Through this approach, children develop confidence, self-discipline, and a lifelong love of learning within a calm and purposeful environment.

Ungraded Classroom

Individual materials accommodate varied abilities. Mixed-age groups (18 months-12 years) promote peer learning in a non-competitive setting, as Maria Montessori noted: “There is a communication and harmony between children...”

Parent Involvement

Join us for events like Christmas Open House, Mother’s day tea, Father’s day BBQ, Parent – teacher interview, Olympics, and Graduation to celebrate your child’s learning.

Montessori School History

Dr. Maria Montessori believed education is self-driven, cultivating a lifelong love of learning through choice and perfected tools, not rigid facts.

Montessori Curriculum

Areas include Practical Life, Sensorial, Language, Mathematics, Music, Dance, Yoga, Cultural Awareness, Geography, Science/Nature, History, Arts/Crafts.

Practical Life Exercises

“A child’s work is to create the man he will become.” Activities (e.g., pouring water, scrubbing) build coordination, concentration, attention to detail, and good habits. Montessori Learning Centre

Sensorial Exercises

Materials isolate qualities (color, shape) to sharpen awareness, categorization, and conscious knowledge.

Language

We leverage young children’s fascination with words for early reading/writing, often starting with movable letters.

Mathematics

Concrete materials make arithmetic joyful and intuitive.

Physical and Health Education

Health/Nutrition: Casual lessons on food groups lead to cooking activities.

Physical Education: Dance, drama, and sports promote fitness.

Yoga for Young Children

Natural movements enhance harmony, led by a qualified instructor.

Cultural Awareness

A “Cosmic Plan” view connects all subjects (science, history, arts) to enrich global understanding.

Annual Montessori Summer Olympics

In June, children choose a country, research with parents, prepare a dish for a potluck, and enjoy Olympic games—a family event.

Geography

Global focus on continents using globes, tied to children's experiences. Montessori Learning Centre

Science and Nature

Observation and classification foster ecological respect via zoology (animal cards) and botany (nature tables).

History

A broad-to-detailed, interdependent approach builds planetary responsibility.

Arts and Crafts

Daily opportunities for expression nurture "a sensitive soul."

Music

Rhythm-based activities include singing and movement.

Parent Issues and Concerns Policy and Procedures

Date Policy and Procedures Established: April 30, 2026

Date Policy and Procedures Updated: April 30, 2026

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide a clear, transparent, and consistent process for parents/guardians to raise and resolve concerns related to the operation of Tiffin Bay Montessori.

Definitions

Licensee: The corporation responsible for the operation of the childcare centre.

Supervisor: The individual designated by the licensee to oversee the day-to-day operations of the centre.

Staff: Employees of Tiffin Bay Montessori, including RECEs, assistants, and support staff.

Policy

General

Parents/guardians are encouraged to take an active role in the child care centre and regularly communicate with staff regarding their child's experiences.

Tiffin Bay Montessori supports positive and responsive interactions among children, parents/guardians, and staff, and promotes ongoing communication about the program and each child's development.

The Supervisor is available to support parents/guardians and ensure a positive and respectful experience during all interactions. Our supervisors are available to engage parents/guardians in conversations and support a positive experience during every interaction.

All issues and concerns raised by parents/guardians are taken seriously by Tiffin Bay Montessori staff and will be addressed. Every effort will be made to address and resolve issues and concerns to the satisfaction of all parties and as quickly as possible.

Issues/concerns may be brought forward verbally or in writing. Responses and outcomes will be provided verbally, or in writing upon request. The level of detail provided to the parent/guardian will respect and maintain the confidentiality of all parties involved.

An initial response to an issue or concern will be provided to parents/guardians within 2-5 business day(s). The person who raised the issue/concern will be kept informed throughout the resolution process.

Investigations of issues and concerns will be fair, impartial and respectful to parties involved.

Confidentiality

Every issue and concern will be treated confidentially and every effort will be made to protect the privacy of parents/guardians, children, Educators, other persons in the premises, staff, students and volunteers, except when information must be disclosed for legal reasons (e.g. to the Ministry of Education, College of Early Childhood Educators, law enforcement authorities or a Children's Aid Society).

Conduct

Our agency maintains high standards for positive interaction, communication and role-modeling for children. Harassment and discrimination will therefore not be tolerated from any party.

If at any point a parent/guardian, Educator, Educator and/or staff feels uncomfortable, threatened, abused or belittled, they may immediately end the conversation and report the situation to the Supervisor or Licensee.

Concerns about the Suspected Abuse or Neglect of a child

Everyone, including members of the public and professionals who work closely with children, is required by law to report suspected cases of child abuse or neglect.

Tiffin Bay Montessori School



If a parent/guardian expresses concerns that a child is being abused or neglected, the parent will be advised to contact the local Children's Aid Society (CAS) directly.

Persons who become aware of such concerns are also responsible for reporting this information to CAS as per the "Duty to Report" requirement under the *Child and Family Services Act*.

For more information, visit

<http://www.children.gov.on.ca/htdocs/English/childrensaidthereportingabuse/index.aspx>

Procedures

Nature of Issue or Concern	Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:	Steps for Provider, Staff and/or Licensee in responding to issue/concern:
Program-Related E.g: schedule, toilet training, indoor/outdoor program activities, menus, etc.	Raise the issue or concern to - the child care centre/in home-services provider directly or - the Supervisor and/or licensee.	- Address the issue/concern at the time it is raised; or - arrange for a meeting with the parent/guardian within 2-5 business days.
General, Agency- or Operations-Related E.g: fees, placement, etc.	Raise the issue or concern to: - the Supervisor or licensee.	Document the issues/concerns in detail. Documentation should include: - the date and time the issue/concern was received; - the name of the person who received the issue/concern; - the name of the person reporting the issue/concern; - the details of the issue/concern; and - any steps taken to resolve the issue/concern and/or information given to the parent/guardian regarding next steps or referral.
Provider-, Staff- and/or Licensee-Related E.g: conduct of provider, Supervisor, staff, etc.	Raise the issue or concern to - the individual directly or - the licensee. All issues or concerns about the conduct of the childcare centre/Educator or staff that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the supervisor as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation.	Provide contact information for the appropriate person if the person being notified is unable to address the matter.
Related to Other Persons at the Home Premises	Raise the issue or concern to - the childcare centre or staff directly or - the Supervisor and/or licensee All issues or concerns about the conduct of other persons in a childcare centre premises that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the Supervisor as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation.	Ensure the investigation of the issue/concern is initiated by the appropriate party within 2-5 business days or as soon as reasonably possible thereafter. Document reasons for delays in writing. Provide a resolution or outcome to the parent(s)/guardian(s) who raised the issue/concern.
Student- / Volunteer-Related	Raise the issue or concern to - the person responsible for supervising the volunteer or student or	

Nature of Issue or Concern	Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:	Steps for Provider, Staff and/or Licensee in responding to issue/concern:
	- the Supervisor and/or licensee. Note: All issues or concerns about the conduct of students/volunteers that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the agency Supervisor as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation.	

Escalation of Issues or Concerns: Where parents/guardians are not satisfied with the response or outcome of an issue or concern, they may escalate the issue or concern verbally or in writing to inquires@midland-montessori.ca

Issues/concerns related to compliance with requirements set out in the *Childcare and Early Years Act., 2014* and Ontario Regulation 137/15 must be reported to the Ministry of Education's Childcare Quality Assurance and Licensing Branch.

Issues/concerns may also be reported to other relevant regulatory bodies (e.g. local public health department, police department, Ministry of Environment, Ministry of Labour, fire department, College of Early Childhood Educators, Ontario College of Teachers, College of Social Workers etc.) where appropriate.

Contacts:

Ministry of Education, Licensed Childcare Help Desk: 1-877-510-5333 or childcare_ontario@ontario.ca

Tiffin Bay Montessori – Inquires@midland-montessori.ca

Parent/Guardian Resources

At Tiffin Bay Montessori, we value staying informed and connected to best practices in early learning and care. The following resources support families in understanding child development, Montessori principles, and Ontario's childcare framework:

1. **How Does Learning Happen? – Ontario's Pedagogy for the Early Years**
<https://www.ontario.ca/page/how-does-learning-happen-ontarios-pedagogy-early-years>
2. **Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014 (CCEYA)**
<https://www.ontario.ca/laws/statute/14c11>
3. **Ministry of Education – Child Care and Early Years Information**
<https://www.ontario.ca/page/child-care-and-early-years>
4. **Think, Feel, Act: Lessons from Research about Young Children**
<https://www.ontario.ca/page/think-feel-act-lessons-research-about-young-children>
5. **Child Care Information for Families (Ontario)**
<https://www.ontario.ca/page/find-quality-child-care>

Parent Handbook Updates & Revisions

Tiffin Bay Montessori will update this Parent Handbook as required to reflect current requirements from the Ministry of Education, Ministry of Health, and ongoing centre practices.

Families will be notified of any significant updates or revisions through email and the **ClassDojo** app.

Freedom of Information & Protection of Privacy Form

Acknowledgment, Authorization, and Consent to the Collection, Use and Disclosure of Personal Information

TO:

Tiffin Bay Montessori School
788 Yonge Street, Midland, ON

FROM:

(Parent/Guardian Name)

The undersigned Parent/Guardian acknowledges and consents to the following:

1. That my child, _____ (Child's Name), is enrolled at Tiffin Bay Montessori School and is a minor.
2. That Tiffin Bay Montessori School will collect personal information related to my child and family for the purpose of providing childcare services and maintaining required records.
3. That such information may include, but is not limited to:
 - Parent/guardian name
 - Child's name, date of birth, immunization records, and health information
 - Emergency contact information
 - Email address, mailing address, and telephone number
 - Billing and account information
 - Any other information necessary to support the care, safety, and well-being of my child
4. That all personal information will be collected, used, stored, and protected in accordance with applicable privacy legislation and Tiffin Bay Montessori School policies.
5. That personal information may be disclosed when required by law or where necessary to support the health, safety, and well-being of my child (e.g., Ministry of Education, public health authorities, or Children's Aid Society).
6. That by signing below, I provide consent for Tiffin Bay Montessori School to collect, use, and disclose personal information as outlined above.

Dated this _____ day of _____, 20_____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

TIFFIN BAY MONTESSORI



Signature: _____

Witness Name: _____

Witness Signature: _____

Parent Handbook Agreement For

Tiffin Bay Montessori School

788 Yonge Street, Midland, ON

I, _____ (Parent/Guardian),
parent/legal guardian of _____ (Child's Name),

confirm that I have received, read, and understand the **Tiffin Bay Montessori Parent Handbook**, and agree to follow all policies, procedures, and expectations. I understand these are in place to support the safety, well-being, and quality of care for all children, families, and staff.

This form must be signed and returned prior to the child's first day of attendance.

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Parent Agreement

Tiffin Bay Montessori School

788 Yonge St, Midland, ON L4R 3M7

I/We _____,
residing at _____,
being the _____ of _____,

request enrollment of my/our child _____ for daytime
care at Tiffin Bay Montessori School and agree to the following terms:

1. **Tuition:** \$_____ covering care from _____ to _____, days:

Payment Schedule:
A _____ B _____ C _____
D _____ E _____ F _____
2. **Payment Terms:** Tuition is due on the **4th operating day of each month** via pre-authorized debit (PAD).
3. **Arrears:** If tuition is **2 weeks overdue** without an approved arrangement, the school may terminate enrollment.
4. **NSF Fee:** A fee of **\$45.00** will be charged for insufficient funds.
5. **Fees & Absences:** No refunds or fee reductions will be provided for absences. Full fees apply during holidays and scheduled closures.
6. **Fees & Absences:** No fee reductions or refunds will be provided for absences for any reason. Full fees apply during holidays, closures, P.D. Days, winter break, illness, or any leave.
7. **Enrollment & Withdrawal:** Enrollment is for a full academic year. Parents must enroll in PAD. A minimum of **four (4) weeks written notice** or fees in lieu is required for withdrawal. No refunds will be issued for less than one month's notice.
8. **Allergies/Health:** Parents/guardians are responsible for informing the school of any medical conditions, allergies, or health concerns affecting their child.
9. **Arrival & Dismissal:** Parents/guardians are responsible for daily drop-off and pick-up and must notify the school of any changes to authorized pick-up persons. Delays must be communicated. A late fee of **\$2 per minute after 5:30 PM** will apply.
10. **Emergency Contacts:** Parents must provide at least **two emergency contacts** and notify the school of any updates.
11. **Emergency Care:** In the event of an emergency where parents cannot be reached, the school is authorized to seek medical treatment (doctor, dentist, or hospital) as deemed necessary.
12. **Probation & Termination:** The first **four (4) weeks** are a probationary period. If the child is not ready, fees will be refunded. Enrollment may also be terminated for non-payment or failure to cooperate with school policies.

TIFFIN BAY MONTESSORI



Acknowledgment

The undersigned confirm they have read, understand, and agree to abide by all terms of this agreement and the school's policies and procedures.

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____ Date: _____ Parent/Guardian
Signature: _____ Date: _____

Director, Tiffin Bay Montessori School: _____

Tiffin Bay Montessori

788 Yong St. Midland, ON L4R 3M7

MEDICAL AUTHORIZATION FORM

I hereby grant permission to Tiffin Bay Montessori School to provide medical care for my child in case of sudden illness or injury occurring while my/our child is under supervision of the school.

In case of such an illness or injury, I understand that School representative will take my/our child to the doctor's office or hospital. I understand that the school will make every effort to contact me in case of an emergency.

Child's Name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Witnessed By: _____ Date: _____